> They (Mughal forces) were given directions to show consideration and favour to all people who would come across their way so that they were not forced to abandon their homes.

Faced with defections and disunity, Yakub Chak was unable to resist the combined Mughal–Kashmir army, which marched into Srinagar on 7 October 1586.

As for Raja Bhagwant Das, he would never again be asked to campaign and, from the time of his recovery till his death in 1589, he was put in charge of the royal harem. For the pragmatic Akbar the extreme action of Bhagwant Das appeared profoundly mystifying. As the Jesuits had written of Akbar, 'He is willing to consult about his affairs, and often takes advice in private from his friends near his person, but the decision, as it ought, always rests with the king'. It was perfectly in order for Akbar to reserve the final decision on the treaty with Kashmir to himself. Moreover, as the Jesuits had noted, Akbar behaved 'so sternly towards the nobles who are under his proud sway that each one of them believes himself to be regarded not only as a contemptible creature but as the very lowest and meanest of mankind. For instance, these nobles, if they commit offences, are punished more severely and relentlessly than the rest of the people, even those of the meanest degree.' Given the fact that he censured his generals routinely, it was natural for him to be surprised by Raja Bhagwant Das's reaction. However, there had been several instances when the actions of Rajput men and women were ascribed to a sort of insanity, a familial malady, by bemused Mughal chroniclers. For the Rajputs, their word and their honour as warriors and chiefs were as unalterable as the rising of the sun. Death, as sung by the Charans, was a far easier alternative to a life without honour. The Bhagwant Das episode, then, was one where the fine balance between the Padshah being the final authority on key matters and the Rajput code of honour was disturbed. However, having exerted his authority, Akbar did everything he could to take care of his courtier.

By giving Bhagwant Das charge of the imperial household Akbar was keeping the raja close at hand, where his well-being could be monitored, while, at the same time giving him one of the highest honours of the land. Only the most trustworthy officers, who enjoyed the Padshah's complete confidence, were ever given this charge, which included control of the royal bodyguard and the supervision of all provisions and articles required for the comfort and safety of the harem women. On a more personal note, these last